For Trishul, I was looking for a man who not only had a sound knowledge of electronics and missile warfare, but who could also communicate the complexities to his team in order to promote understanding and to earn his team's support. I found in Cmde SR Mohan, who sailed into Defence R&D from the Indian Navy, a talent for detail and an almost magical power of persuasion.

For Agni, my dream project, I needed somebody who would tolerate my occasional meddling in the running of this project. In RN Agarwal I found the right person. He was an alumnus of MIT with a bril iant academic record and had been managing the Aeronautical Test Facilities at DRDL with keen professional acumen.

Due to technological complexities, Akash and Nag were then considered missiles of the future; their activities were expected to peak about half a decade later.

Therefore, I selected the relatively young Prahlada and NR Iyer for Akash and Nag. Two other young men, VK Saraswat and AK Kapoor were made deputies to Sundaram and Mohan respectively.

In those days, there was no forum in DRDL where issues of general importance could be openly discussed